

CENTRAL BOARD OF SECONDARY EDUCATION — PRACTICE EXAMINATION**CLASS IX • SOCIAL SCIENCE (SUBJECT CODE: 087) • ACADEMIC SESSION 2026-27****SET E — CASE STUDY & SOURCE-BASED SCENARIOS****CHAPTER 07: ELECTIONS**

TIME ALLOWED: 45 MINUTES

MAXIMUM MARKS: 25 MARKS

SERIES: CBS-IX-SST-SET-E-07

Student's Name: _____

Roll No.: _____

Class & Section: Class IX - _____

Date of Exam: _____

Invigilator's Sign: _____

General Instructions (SET E - Case Study & Source-Based Scenarios):

1. The question paper comprises **5 In-Depth Case Studies & Source Scenarios** with **5 MCQs each (Total: 25 Questions, 1 Mark each)**.
2. Read each source passage, historical inscription, geographic case, and economic scenario carefully before answering the corresponding questions.
3. Each question has 4 options with a single correct answer.
4. All questions are compulsory. There is no negative marking.
5. Darken the corresponding bubble on the **OMR Sheet** completely using a blue/black ballpoint pen.

CASE STUDY 1: DELIMITATION & AFFIRMATIVE ACTION: THE RESERVED CONSTITUENCY ARCHITECTURE

The Constitution of India established a representative parliamentary democracy with 543 territorial constituencies electing members to the Lok Sabha. To prevent the permanent exclusion of historically oppressed and marginalized social groups, the Constitution framers, led by Dr. B. R. Ambedkar, designed a system of 'Reserved Constituencies'. In an open first-past-the-post electoral contest, scattered marginalized populations might never possess the arithmetic majority to elect candidates from their own communities against dominant, resource-rich social elites. Consequently, specific constituencies are legally reserved: currently, 84 seats are reserved for Scheduled Castes (SC) and 47 seats for Scheduled Tribes (ST) in the Lok Sabha. In an SC or ST reserved constituency, all registered voters regardless of caste or community cast their ballots, but only candidates belonging to the designated SC or ST category are legally eligible to contest. Constituency boundaries are periodically redrawn by an independent Delimitation Commission to ensure each parliamentary seat represents roughly equal population quotas.

Q.1 Why did the makers of the Indian Constitution introduce the system of Reserved Constituencies for the Lok Sabha?

- | | |
|--|---|
| (A) To prevent upper-caste citizens from voting in general elections | (B) To guarantee fair political representation for historically oppressed SC and ST communities in Parliament |
| (C) To ensure that elections take place only once every fifty years | (D) To divide India into separate independent sovereign countries |

Q.2 In a parliamentary constituency reserved for Scheduled Castes (SC), who is legally entitled to vote?

- | | |
|--|--|
| (A) Only registered voters belonging to the Scheduled Caste category | (B) All eligible registered voters living within the constituency, regardless of their caste, religion, or community |
| (C) Only university graduates and government officers | (D) Only citizens owning more than 10 acres of land |

Q.3 How many seats are currently reserved for Scheduled Castes (SC) and Scheduled Tribes (ST) respectively in the Lok Sabha?

- | | |
|---|---|
| (A) 10 seats for SC and 5 seats for ST | (B) 84 seats for SC and 47 seats for ST |
| (C) 200 seats for SC and 150 seats for ST | (D) Zero seats for both |

Q.4 What independent constitutional body is responsible for demarcating and redrawing the geographic boundaries of parliamentary constituencies?

- | | |
|---------------------------------|---|
| (A) The Delimitation Commission | (B) The Union Public Service Commission |
| (C) The NITI Aayog | (D) The Reserve Bank of India |

Q.5 What core democratic principle is protected by redrawing constituency boundaries to balance population sizes?

- | | |
|--|---|
| (A) Dynastic succession of political families | (B) 'One person, one vote, one value'—ensuring each parliamentary representative speaks for an approximately equal number of citizens |
| (C) Allowing small cities to control the national budget | (D) Eliminating the need for a national census |

CASE STUDY 2: CONSTITUTIONAL AUTONOMY & PLENARY POWERS OF THE ELECTION COMMISSION (ECI)

The Election Commission of India (ECI) stands as an autonomous constitutional monolith tasked with ensuring free, fair, and impartial elections. Under Article 324 of the Constitution, the superintendence, direction, and control of all elections to Parliament, State Legislatures, and the offices of the President and Vice-President are vested in the ECI. To safeguard its institutional independence from the ruling political executive, the Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) is appointed by the President but enjoys security of tenure identical to that of a Supreme Court judge: the CEC cannot be removed by the executive, except through impeachment by both Houses of Parliament with a special two-thirds majority on grounds of proved misbehavior or incapacity. During elections, the ECI exercises plenary administrative control over millions of state civil servants and police personnel placed on statutory deputation. If widespread booth capturing, violence, or electronic tampering occurs, the ECI has the absolute constitutional authority to countermand polls, disqualify candidates, and order fresh repolls.

Q.6 Which article of the Constitution of India vests the superintendence, direction, and control of elections in the Election Commission?

- | | |
|-----------------|-----------------|
| (A) Article 21 | (B) Article 324 |
| (C) Article 370 | (D) Article 356 |

Q.7 How is the institutional independence of the Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) protected against ruling government pressure?

- | | |
|---|---|
| (A) The CEC commands his own private army of tanks | (B) The CEC enjoys security of tenure and can only be removed through parliamentary impeachment with a special majority, like a Supreme Court judge |
| (C) The CEC is appointed for life and never retires | (D) The CEC lives outside of India in a secret location |

Q.8 Under whose administrative control do civil servants, teachers, and police personnel operate when on election duty?

- | | |
|--|---|
| (A) Their respective state political chief ministers | (B) Directly under the Election Commission of India on statutory deputation |
| (C) Under private political party committees | (D) Under municipal corporations |

Q.9 What action can the Election Commission take if widespread rigging or booth capturing is detected at a polling station?

- | | |
|--|--|
| (A) Declare the corrupt candidate the immediate winner | (B) Countermand the election and order a fresh, heavily monitored repoll |
| (C) Ignore the incident and destroy all ballot papers | (D) Close the polling station permanently for the next century |

Q.10 Which elections are NOT conducted by the Election Commission of India (ECI)?

- | | |
|--|--|
| (A) Lok Sabha general elections | (B) State Legislative Assembly elections |
| (C) Panchayat and Municipal local body elections (conducted by State Election Commissions) | (D) Presidential elections |

CASE STUDY 3: THE MODEL CODE OF CONDUCT (MCC): ENFORCING A LEVEL PLAYING FIELD

The Model Code of Conduct (MCC) is a set of standardized operational guidelines agreed upon by political parties to govern campaigning conduct during elections. The MCC comes into legal effect the exact second the Election Commission of India formally announces election dates at its press conference, remaining active until results are officially declared. The overarching objective of the MCC is to preserve a level playing field and prevent the ruling party from misusing public office to engineer an unfair electoral advantage. Under the MCC: (1) Ministers and ruling leaders cannot use official government aircraft, vehicles, or state bungalows for electioneering; (2) No government advertisements praising party achievements can be released at public taxpayers' expense; (3) Ministers are strictly prohibited from laying foundation stones, announcing discretionary welfare grants, or promising new infrastructure projects once dates are declared; (4) Political parties and candidates cannot appeal to caste, religious, or communal sentiments, nor use religious places (temples, mosques, churches) for election propaganda.

Q.11 When does the Model Code of Conduct (MCC) come into operational effect during general elections?

- | | |
|---|---|
| (A) On the day of counting when votes are tallied | (B) Immediately upon the formal announcement of election dates by the Election Commission |
| (C) Only on the actual morning of voting | (D) Six months after the new government takes oath |

Q.12 Why does the Model Code of Conduct prohibit ruling ministers from laying foundation stones or announcing financial grants during campaigns?

- | | |
|---|---|
| (A) Because engineers are not allowed to build roads during the monsoon | (B) To prevent ruling politicians from using state funds and promises to unduly bribe or influence voter choice on the eve of polls |
| (C) Because all construction in India is banned by law | (D) To save cement and bricks for temple architecture |

Q.13 Under the Model Code of Conduct, which of the following campaign activities is strictly illegal?

- (A) Distributing printed party manifestos outlining economic policies
- (B) Using religious places of worship for campaign speeches or appealing to voters on communal caste lines
- (C) Holding peaceful public meetings with prior police permission
- (D) Going door-to-door to talk with neighborhood families

Q.14 How does the MCC restrict ruling party ministers regarding official government transportation?

- (A) Ministers must walk on foot everywhere
- (B) Ministers are strictly forbidden from using official state vehicles, government aircraft, or bureaucratic staff for election campaigning
- (C) Ministers can use air force fighter jets to drop party flags
- (D) Ministers are required to purchase commercial airlines

Q.15 What happens if a candidate or political party repeatedly violates the Model Code of Conduct?

- (A) The candidate is given a national award
- (B) The ECI can issue reprimands, ban the candidate from campaigning for specified periods, or file criminal FIRs under electoral law
- (C) The ECI shuts down all television stations in the country
- (D) Nothing happens because the MCC is totally meaningless

CASE STUDY 4: TECHNOLOGICAL INTEGRITY: THE STANDALONE EVM & VVPAT VERIFICATION ARCHITECTURE

India transitioned from paper ballots to Electronic Voting Machines (EVMs) to eliminate ballot-box stuffing, eliminate invalid votes, and ensure rapid, error-free counting. Engineered by public sector giants Bharat Electronics Limited (BEL) and Electronics Corporation of India Limited (ECIL), Indian EVMs possess a uniquely secure architecture. An EVM is a completely standalone, battery-powered embedded microcontroller device. It has zero wireless connectivity: no Wi-Fi, no Bluetooth, no internet ports, and no external operating system. Its firmware is permanently etched into One-Time Programmable (OTP) masked microchips at the factory stage, making software tampering or remote hacking mathematically impossible. To provide physical paper verification, the Voter Verifiable Paper Audit Trail (VVPAT) was introduced. When a voter presses a candidate button on the Balloting Unit, the VVPAT prints a paper slip showing the candidate's serial number, name, and symbol. The slip remains visible behind a transparent illuminated glass window for 7 seconds, allowing the voter to verify their vote before dropping into a sealed drop-box. Following Supreme Court directives, VVPAT paper slips from five randomly selected polling booths per assembly segment are physically hand-counted to cross-verify EVM counts.

Q.16 Why are Indian Electronic Voting Machines (EVMs) immune to remote internet hacking or wireless interception?

- (A) They are equipped with high-speed satellite 5G antennae
- (B) They are completely standalone offline microcontroller devices with zero internet, Wi-Fi, or Bluetooth network capabilities
- (C) They run on standard Microsoft Windows desktop operating systems
- (D) They are kept under water during the voting process

Q.17 What is the function of the Voter Verifiable Paper Audit Trail (VVPAT) connected to the EVM?

- (A) It calculates the monetary cost of the election per minute (B) It prints a paper slip displaying the candidate's name, serial number, and symbol for 7 seconds, verifying the vote before dropping into a sealed box
- (C) It allows voters to take a selfie and post it online (D) It prints a paper receipt that voters can take home to show their family

Q.18 What type of microchip architecture ensures that EVM firmware cannot be overwritten or altered after manufacturing?

- (A) Cloud-connected rewriteable flash drives (B) One-Time Programmable (OTP) masked microchips burnt permanently at the factory stage
- (C) Removable magnetic cassette tapes (D) USB thumb drives updated daily from the internet

Q.19 How many randomly selected polling stations per assembly constituency must undergo mandatory physical VVPAT paper slip tallying under Supreme Court guidelines?

- (A) Zero polling stations (B) Five polling stations per assembly segment
- (C) All 100% of polling stations in the entire nation (D) Only one polling station in all of India

Q.20 What major historical problem associated with old paper ballot voting was completely eliminated by the introduction of EVMs?

- (A) The problem of printing too many school textbooks (B) Invalid and rejected votes due to smudged ink stamps, as well as physical ballot-box snatching and stuffing
- (C) The existence of political parties (D) Having to count votes on a television channel

CASE STUDY 5: PARTICIPATORY TRENDS: THE UNIQUE INDIAN ELECTORAL TURNOUT PARADOX

Political scientists studying comparative global electoral behavior highlight a fascinating democratic phenomenon known as the 'Indian Turnout Paradox'. In established Western advanced democracies, such as the United States and the United Kingdom, voter turnout correlates positively with socioeconomic privilege: wealthy, highly educated, upper-income citizens participate at significantly higher rates than low-income, marginalized, and minority demographics. In India, the participatory dynamic is completely inverted. Turnout among poor, rural, illiterate, and marginalized citizens (Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes, and Other Backward Classes) is routinely higher than among affluent, urban, highly educated elites. Sociological fieldwork explains this divergence: for India's marginalized masses, the voting ballot represents their most potent, non-negotiable instrument of social agency and dignity. It is their primary constitutional lever to extract welfare entitlements (subsidized food rations, rural employment guarantees, piped drinking water, and housing grants) and hold powerful local elites accountable. In contrast, urban middle-class cynicism and residential mobility often manifest as lower urban voter turnout.

Q.21 What is the 'Indian Turnout Paradox' observed by political scientists comparing India with Western democracies?

- (A) In India, nobody ever votes in any election (B) Poor, rural, and socially marginalized citizens vote in higher proportions than wealthy, urban, highly educated elites
- (C) Only foreign tourists participate in Indian elections (D) Voting is legally compulsory for every citizen in India

Q.22 Why do marginalized and rural citizens in India view the voting process as profoundly important to their daily lives?

- (A) They receive free commercial airline tickets at the polling booth
- (B) The vote is their primary constitutional instrument to demand dignity, welfare entitlements, basic services, and hold rulers accountable
- (C) They are forced to vote by private employers
- (D) They believe voting changes the weather

Q.23 How does voter turnout in urban metropolitan constituencies in India generally compare to rural farming constituencies?

- (A) Urban areas always achieve 100% turnout while rural areas achieve 0%
- (B) Urban areas frequently exhibit 'urban voter apathy', recording noticeably lower turnout than rural agrarian districts
- (C) There are no polling booths in Indian cities
- (D) Both areas record exactly identical voter numbers down to the last person

Q.24 What constitutional amendment lowered the voting age in India from 21 years to 18 years, expanding democratic youth participation?

- (A) 42nd Amendment Act
- (B) 61st Constitutional Amendment Act (1988)
- (C) 73rd Amendment Act
- (D) 100th Amendment Act

Q.25 What photo identity document issued by the ECI serves as universal proof of registration on the electoral roll?

- (A) EPIC (Elector's Photo Identity Card)
- (B) Driving license exclusively
- (C) PAN card only
- (D) School report card

CBSE CANDIDATE OMR ANSWER RESPONSE GRID (SET E)

01	(A) (B) (C) (D)	02	(A) (B) (C) (D)	03	(A) (B) (C) (D)	04	(A) (B) (C) (D)	05	(A) (B) (C) (D)
06	(A) (B) (C) (D)	07	(A) (B) (C) (D)	08	(A) (B) (C) (D)	09	(A) (B) (C) (D)	10	(A) (B) (C) (D)
11	(A) (B) (C) (D)	12	(A) (B) (C) (D)	13	(A) (B) (C) (D)	14	(A) (B) (C) (D)	15	(A) (B) (C) (D)
16	(A) (B) (C) (D)	17	(A) (B) (C) (D)	18	(A) (B) (C) (D)	19	(A) (B) (C) (D)	20	(A) (B) (C) (D)
21	(A) (B) (C) (D)	22	(A) (B) (C) (D)	23	(A) (B) (C) (D)	24	(A) (B) (C) (D)	25	(A) (B) (C) (D)

Total Questions Attempted: ____ / 25

Marks Obtained: ____ / 25

Evaluator's Signature: _____

OFFICIAL ANSWER KEY & CASE STUDY ANALYTICAL EXPLANATIONS (SET E)

Q. No.	Correct	Curricular Source Analysis & Conceptual Explanation
Q.1	(B)	Reserved seats ensure that marginalized communities have guaranteed legislative voices, preventing majoritarian exclusion in first-past-the-post elections.
Q.2	(B)	In reserved seats, the entire electorate votes normally; the restriction applies solely to the category of candidates who may contest.
Q.3	(B)	Currently, 84 seats are reserved for Scheduled Castes and 47 seats for Scheduled Tribes in the 543-member Lok Sabha.
Q.4	(A)	The Delimitation Commission is tasked with demarcating parliamentary boundaries based on decennial census demographic data.
Q.5	(B)	Equalizing constituency population ratios guarantees that votes across different districts carry equal representation weight in Parliament.
Q.6	(B)	Article 324 establishes the independent Election Commission and vests it with complete superintendence of national and state elections.
Q.7	(B)	Security of tenure identical to a Supreme Court judge prevents the ruling government from arbitrarily dismissing an impartial CEC.
Q.8	(B)	During elections, all government polling personnel operate under the disciplinary control of the ECI, shielding them from partisan retaliation.
Q.9	(B)	The ECI possesses plenary authority under the Representation of the People Act to void tainted polls and conduct fresh repolls.
Q.10	(C)	Local panchayat and municipality elections are conducted by separate State Election Commissions (under Articles 243K and 243ZA).
Q.11	(B)	The MCC takes effect the instant the Election Commission announces the election schedule, preventing policy distortions.
Q.12	(B)	Banning last-minute government project announcements prevents ruling incumbents from using public coffers to lure voters.
Q.13	(B)	Appeals based on religion, caste, or race, as well as holding political rallies inside places of worship, are strictly prohibited under the MCC and RPA.
Q.14	(B)	Official state machinery, aircraft, and government vehicles cannot be used for partisan campaigning to ensure a level playing field.
Q.15	(B)	The ECI censures violators, imposes campaign bans (e.g., 48 or 72-hour muzzles), and initiates criminal prosecution for statutory violations.
Q.16	(B)	Indian EVMs have no network connectivity, wireless transceivers, or operating systems, making remote network intrusion impossible.
Q.17	(B)	The VVPAT allows the voter to visually verify their vote for 7 seconds through a glass window, preserving a paper trail for manual audit.
Q.18	(B)	One-Time Programmable (OTP) masked silicon chips burn code permanently, preventing any post-manufacturing code changes or overwrites.
Q.19	(B)	Under Supreme Court directives, VVPAT slips from five randomly chosen polling stations per assembly constituency are manually tallied against EVM counts.

Q. No.	Correct	Curricular Source Analysis & Conceptual Explanation
Q.20	(B)	EVMs eliminated millions of rejected/invalid votes caused by improper ink stamping, while electronically preventing rapid bulk box stuffing.
Q.21	(B)	Unlike Western democracies where the rich vote more, in India, underprivileged and rural citizens participate at higher rates than urban elites.
Q.22	(B)	Voting provides marginalized groups with concrete bargaining power to secure public welfare programs, infrastructure, and legal protection.
Q.23	(B)	Indian metropolitan constituencies frequently suffer from urban apathy, registering lower participation rates than rural districts.
Q.24	(B)	The 61st Amendment Act of 1988 lowered the universal voting age from 21 to 18 years, enfranchising millions of young citizens.
Q.25	(A)	The Elector's Photo Identity Card (EPIC) is issued by the Election Commission to prevent impersonation and verify voter registration.